GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

March 27th, 2026
Week 13
Volume 282, Issue 1228

Highlights:

- **Post hols mood.**
- **Currency woes.**
- **Supply slow.**
- **Bangla bullish.**
- **Conflict reigns.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"The two most powerful warriors are patience and time."

-Leo Tolstoy

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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WAIT GOES ON!

As the world's ship recycling markets emerge from the Eid al-Fitr holidays, they do so into an environment that continues to generate more questions than answers. The post-holiday reopening, always anticipated as a potential catalyst for pent-up activity, has instead delivered something more characteristic of the broader 2026 narrative: confusion. Steel plate prices played opposite roles in Pakistan and India this week, as Indian levels recorded an impressive jump while Pakistani levels continued to bleed, declining non-stop over the course of the last month now. Bangladeshi and Chinese levels continued to flatline at the bottom of the pool, offering little directional signal to a market already starved of pricing clarity.

Even the U.S. Dollar, which has otherwise been a reliable source of sub-continent pressure this year, chose this week to remain undecided, making firm improvements against some recycling currencies while losing ground against others. The mixed signals have left buyers and sellers alike struggling to anchor their negotiating positions, and the result has been another week in which market activity remained well below the levels needed to make meaningful inroads into the tonnage backlog that has been building throughout Q1.

Bangladesh has emerged from the Eid break in a surprisingly bullish frame of mind, likely on the back of a few hungry recyclers whose yards have cleared sufficient space to welcome fresh tonnage. This is a noteworthy shift from the cautious posture that defined the Chattogram market through the holiday period. India and Pakistan, by contrast, struggled to keep pace despite the end of the holy month, hampered by the persistent absence of workable tonnage and the ongoing uncertainty around steel economics that has made confident bidding difficult to sustain.

The broader macro context remains unchanged and unresolved. The Middle East conflict continues to keep freight earnings elevated, discouraging owners from sending ageing tonnage for recycling. The Baltic Dry Index has yet to give meaningful ground. Oil remains firmly above USD 100/barrel, reinforcing the perverse arithmetic of a market where higher energy prices translate into longer trading lives for the very vessels that ship recyclers need. As Week 13 closes and Q2 begins, the industry finds itself asking the same question it has asked for most of the past year: when will the tonnage arrive in sufficient quantity to match the appetite that recyclers, particularly in Bangladesh, are beginning to demonstrate?

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 13 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

BANGLA BOON!

Appetite good.

Bangladesh enters the post-Eid period with an appetite that has caught more than a few observers off guard. After weeks of cautious, holiday-dampened sentiment, Chattogram's recyclers appear to have used the festival break to clear inventory, settle financing, and sharpen their pencils for the fresh tonnage hunt that typically follows the Eid pause. The mood at the waterfront is meaningfully more engaged than it was heading into the holiday, with reports of several buyers actively seeking units in the days following the resumption of normal operations.

VLs linger.

The two OFAC-sanctioned VLCCs that have been idling at OPL Chattogram since before the Eid break remain unresolved. As highlighted in last week's edition, both vessels fell afoul of USDN rules and have become victims of OFAC sanctions, with no prospects of a final resting place on the immediate horizon. The episode has sharpened due diligence practices among cash buyers and recyclers, who are now increasingly vigilant in their vetting of proposed tonnage, particularly units that may have changed hands through channels connected to sanctioned parties. Reports suggest there are still a handful of similarly suspect units in cash buyer hands awaiting introduction to the market. Given the fate of the Chattogram duo, how these pending and future dealings will eventually transpire remains very much to be seen.

Steel flat.

Bangladeshi and Chinese steel levels continued to flatline this week, providing little fundamental support for any dramatic upward repricing of recycling offers. The Letter of Credit bottleneck that has frustrated transactions in recent weeks has not yet fully resolved, though there are indications that central bank approvals are beginning to move more smoothly in the post-holiday environment. If that pipeline clears, and if the tonnage that Bangladesh's hungry recyclers are seeking actually materialises, the market could yet see a pre-monsoon burst of activity before the June rains close the window. Whether tonnage availability will cooperate remains the unanswered question.

Yearning supply.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

ON THE LOOKOUT!

India delivered one of the more surprising data points of the week in the form of a sharp upward move in local steel plate prices, an impressive jump that has provided Alang's recyclers with at least a temporary boost to their pricing confidence. The move is a welcome reversal from the prolonged softness that has characterised Indian steel economics for much of Q1, though veterans of the Alang market will be cautious about extrapolating too much from a single week's movement in a market that has demonstrated a pronounced tendency to give back gains almost as quickly as it makes them.

Steel firms.

Lacking tonnage.

The deeper structural challenge at Alang remains unchanged: there is simply not enough workable tonnage arriving at the waterfront. Strong freight earnings, elevated oil prices, and owners' continued preference for keeping aging vessels in service rather than sending them for recycling have combined to leave Alang's anchorage thin and its yards underutilised. The arrival of a handful of smaller regional general cargo vessels, largely units displaced from war-affected trading routes, has provided some activity, but the larger LDT units that Alang's recyclers need to generate meaningful revenue remain stubbornly absent from the demolition pipeline.

India's strongest competitive position continues to be its HKC compliance infrastructure. With more than 110 yards now holding valid Statements of Compliance, Alang is the only sub-continent destination capable of absorbing significant volumes of regulated European and Japanese tonnage at scale. GMS has continued its public advocacy for the inclusion of qualified Indian yards on the EU's approved recycling facility register, noting that continued exclusion appears driven by political considerations rather than compliance standards. Whether that advocacy translates into regulatory progress in Brussels before the next wave of EU-flagged vessels reaches end-of-life will be a defining question for India's medium-term recycling volumes.

Over 100 HKC.

EU questions.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

STILL KEEN!

Seeking tonnage.

Pakistan produced something of a surprise this week, taking in more vessels than India despite a clear overall decline in the number of arrivals and deliveries across the sub-continent board, and despite the ongoing deterioration in local steel plate prices that has become Gadani's most persistent structural headache. Pakistani steel levels have declined non-stop over the last month, a trend that sits in stark contrast to the sharp upward move recorded in India this week and that continues to compress the margin available to Gadani's recyclers on each unit they acquire.

HKC gains.

The tonnage arrivals, modest as they are in absolute terms, nonetheless represent a meaningful signal of continued buyer engagement at Gadani, a market that was effectively written off by much of the industry as recently as twelve months ago. The combination of three new HKC certified yards, the geographic advantage of proximity to Gulf tonnage displaced by the ongoing conflict, and the relative availability of yard space has made Gadani a viable landing point for owners who need a compliant, accessible South Asian alternative to Alang.

Rupee steady.

The Pakistani Rupee's recent steadiness, holding broadly flat after weeks of depreciation pressure, provides at least a temporary floor under Gadani's economics. Should steel prices stabilise and additional HKC certifications materialise in the coming weeks, Pakistan's improved position in the regional competitive landscape could translate into a more sustained flow of tonnage. For now, the market remains a work in progress, better than it was, not yet where it needs to be.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

STEADY BUT SILENT!

Disadvantaged.

Turkey ends Week 13 in much the same position it has occupied for the better part of the year: structurally disadvantaged on price, watching the sub-continent capture what little tonnage is available, and waiting for a market shift that shows no sign of arriving on the immediate horizon. Aliaga's yards continued to operate at subdued levels through the post-Eid week, with no significant sales or major new enquiries reported across the period.

The Turkish Lira's continuing depreciation against the U.S. Dollar remains the defining constraint on Turkish recycling economics. At indicative levels of USD 265-285/LDT depending on vessel type, Aliaga cannot realistically compete with sub-continent pricing for mainstream commercial tonnage. The domestic steel scrap market, which ultimately sets the ceiling on what Turkish recyclers can offer, continues to reflect sluggish demand from the construction sector and the broader uncertainty that has characterised the Turkish economic environment through Q1.

Turkey's structural advantage in the specialist segment, EU-approved yards able to receive EU-flagged vessels under the Ship Recycling Regulation, continues to provide a thin but durable revenue stream for the handful of facilities that hold approved status. The Ege Çelik delisting and the reputational overhang it created for Aliaga's regulatory credibility has not helped, and European owners considering Turkish yards for their regulated tonnage will continue to apply careful scrutiny. For the broader Turkish market, the question of when it next becomes genuinely competitive for international recycling tonnage remains open, and the answer, for now, does not appear to be this week.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 13 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	450 / LDT	470 / LDT	480 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Improving**	440 / LDT	460 / LDT	470 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	425 / LDT	445 / LDT	455 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *Producing approximately 69.16 million tons of steel recovered from ships recycled at Alang to date through iron ore-based production would generate over 95.8 million MT of CO_2.*

- *In contrast, recycling this steel at Alang has avoided approximately 72.55 million MT of CO_2 emissions, equivalent to removing 15.7 million passenger cars from the road for one year.*

- *Steel production via ship recycling is associated with significantly lower water pollution than conventional steelmaking, with studies indicating reductions of up to 76%.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
April 03 – Good Friday	March 31 April 01 – April 06

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
April 14 – Bengali New Year	April 1 – April 4

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
May 01 – Labour Day	April 23 - National Sovereignty and Children's Day

Prices indicated above are as reported in the market and are not necessarily accurate. This information is provided without prejudice and is given in good faith and without any guarantees whatsoever. While every care has been taken in the preparation of this report, no liability can be accepted for any loss incurred in any way whatsoever by any person relying on the information contained herein. Opinions expressed herein may be deemed subjective and arbitrary. This WEEKLY is intended only for the person or entity to which it is addressed and may contain confidential and/or privileged material. Any review, retransmission, dissemination, or other use of this information by persons or entities other than the intended recipient is prohibited.

ALANG - Port Position as of March 27, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Al Diab II	2,329	LPG	*Delivered March 25*
2	Kuljak Arrow	10,241	Bulk Carrier	Arrived March 22
Morality		***12,570***		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of March 27, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
No new vessels reported.				

GADANI - Port Position as of March 27, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
No new vessels reported.				
Total Tonnage		**-**		

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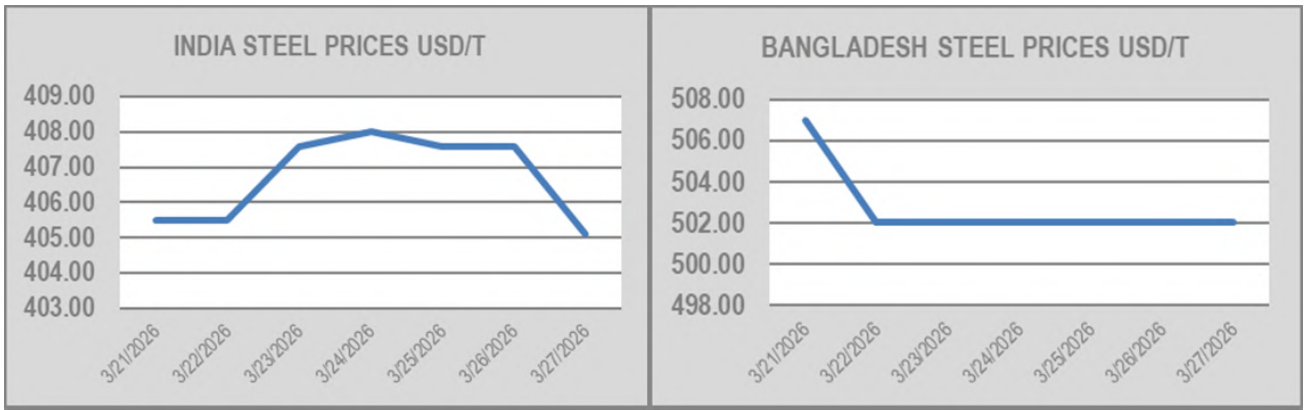
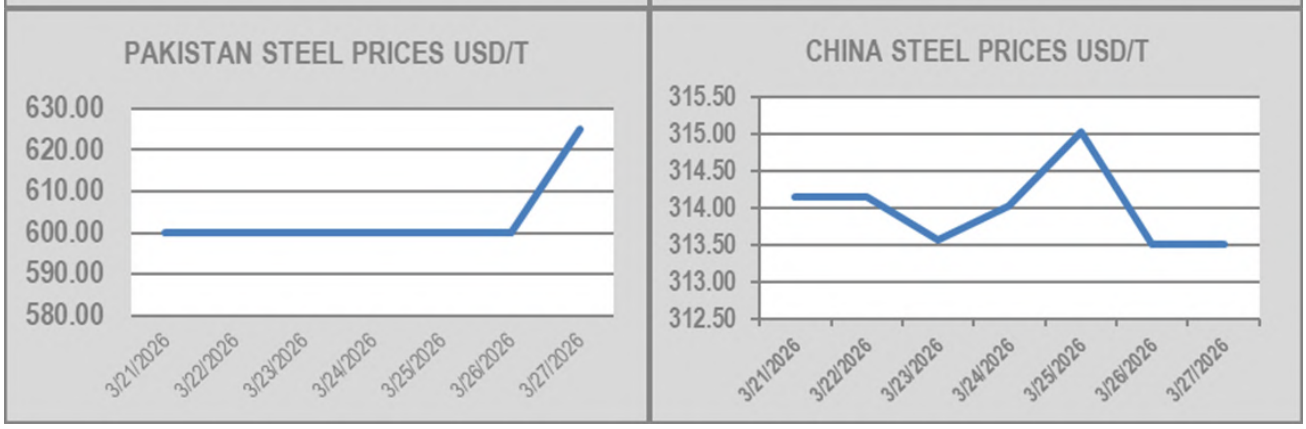
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
3/21/2026	405.51	38,000.00	600.00	168,000.00	506.98	61,000.00	314.15
3/22/2026	405.51	38,000.00	600.00	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.15
3/23/2026	407.58	38,300.00	600.00	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	313.58
3/24/2026	408.01	38,300.00	600.00	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	314.03
3/25/2026	407.58	38,300.00	600.00	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	315.03
3/26/2026	407.58	38,300.00	600.00	168,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	313.51
3/27/2026	405.12	38,300.00	625.00	175,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	313.51





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